

Mark Smalley

Developer Relations · Technical Evangelist · Blockchain Protocol Builder

// the rare DevRel who can write the protocol and explain it on a TED stage

Open to employed roles: UK/Europe & remote globally

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PROFILE

Developer advocate and technical evangelist with 15 years building on, and explaining, blockchain technology. One of Southeast Asia's earliest Bitcoin voices, with a track record of making complex cryptographic concepts accessible to developers, institutions, and the general public alike. Personally designed protocols now running in production (SADO, DN-Key), built open-source SDKs used across the Bitcoin Ordinals ecosystem, and currently shipping open-source game engines with full developer documentation and embed APIs. Spoken at TEDx, FinTech conferences, and developer meetups across Asia and Europe. Using AI-native engineering workflows to ship developer tooling at unprecedented pace. Looking for a DevRel or Technical Evangelist role at a Layer 1/2 protocol, developer tooling company, or infrastructure provider where both the code and the community matter.

PUBLIC CONTENT & COMMUNITY

TALKS & VIDEO

- [TEDx Sarawak \(2017\)](#) — 'The Cost of Cash': demystifying Bitcoin and decentralised money for a mainstream audience — on YouTube
- [WebCamp KL](#) — regular speaker from 2011; [MongoDB CMS Battle](#) (2011, YouTube, official WebCamp KL channel) and 'Introducing Bitcoin' (2013)
- [Neuroware / blockchain speaker \(2016, YouTube\)](#) — developer and institutional audiences on blockchain infrastructure
- [Financial Crime Summit \(2017\)](#), [Finnovasia](#), [MDEC FinTech Conference](#), [Islamic Finance News Forum](#) — regular regional speaker

WRITTEN & PUBLISHED

- 'Unravelling Blockchain's Future' — bylined article in [Islamic Finance News \(IFN\)](#), 2017
- 'My Life on the Blockchain' (LVLUPKL) — [SlideShare](#), covering decentralised infrastructure evolution from 2013
- 'Banking on the Future of Blockchains' — [MDEC FinTech Conference](#) deck, widely circulated on [SlideShare](#)
- 21 technical presentations across two [SlideShare](#) profiles (2012–2018) with 59,000+ cumulative views. 'Introducing Bitcoin' (2013) alone reached 31,500+ views — among the earliest Bitcoin educational content in the region. [slideshare.net/marksmalley1](#)

OPEN SOURCE & DEVELOPER COMMUNITY

- **Moddable Chess Engine** ([chess.moddable.games](#)) — open-source game framework (v0.7.1): 70 chess variants + consumer SDK with renderer hooks, game controller, replay API, and unit templates. [Dungeon Chess](#) runs entirely on MCE as a game subsystem — proving the framework architecture. Tiered plugin system, developer guides, AI with opening books for 26 variants
- **Moddable Hexmaps** ([hex.moddable.games](#)) — open-source hex map framework (v0.5.1): 4 render styles, seeded procedural generation, URL param API, PNG/PDF/SVG export, hex metadata system, and iframe embed support for third-party integration
- **SADO Protocol** ([github.com/sadoprotocol](#)) — co-authored open-source, self-authenticating decentralised order-book for Bitcoin Ordinals; adopted by [Ordzaar](#) and third-party exchanges
- **Ordit SDK** — open-source indexer, parser, and API toolkit for Ordinals and Inscriptions; ~50K npm downloads, multiple repos under [sadoprotocol.org](#)
- **DN-Key Protocol** — authored decentralised key management via DNS TXT records; adopted by [ATA Plus ECF](#) (2016), cited in [SC Malaysia's capital markets blueprint](#) (2018), reused in [Oviato's identity layer](#) (2025)
- **Everstore Protocol** — complete on-chain relational database via BIP32 key derivation: CRUD, encryption, indexing, audit trails (2016, pre-EVM; 25-page whitepaper); featured in [Blockchain Finance](#)
- **BackPress** — core contributor to [Automattic's BackPress](#) framework (WordPress ecosystem)
- Regular speaker at [WebCamp KL](#) from 2011 — one of Malaysia's earliest web and blockchain developer communities
- Founded and operated the **Blockchain Embassy of Asia** — ASEAN's first public blockchain consortium

WORK EXPERIENCE

Chief Blockchain Officer [Oviato](#) — United Kingdom

Feb 2025 – Mar 2026

Co-founded passkey-native wallet infrastructure startup. Built on [Project Eden](#) prototype (weekend hackathon → production). Contributed to the developer narrative and technical positioning that secured [DraperVC](#) investment.

- Built internal cryptographic and passkey/WebAuthN framework — designed for developer-friendly integration by third-party wallet builders
- Articulated complex infrastructure concepts clearly to non-technical investors and partners during the [DraperVC](#) fundraising
- Designed prototypes demonstrating WebAuthN's viability for consumer-grade, non-custodial wallet UX

CEO & Founder (active) [Moddable Limited](#) — United Kingdom

2025 – present

Open-source games studio shipping developer-facing engines, documentation, and tools, built entirely using AI-augmented engineering workflows. Evolved the chess engine into a consumer game framework (v0.7.1) now powering two games from the same core.

- Evolved [Moddable Chess](#) from a 70-variant chess engine into a consumer game SDK — `createGameController()`, `createReplay()`, renderer extension hooks (`tilePainter`, `pieceProvider`), unit templates, and terrain predicates
- Built [Dungeon Chess](#) entirely on MCE's consumer APIs — asymmetric skirmish game with 4 factions, custom renderer hooks, and AI. Proves the framework powers non-chess games without engine forks
- Wrote developer documentation spanning plugins ([Build a Variant](#), [Crazyhouse](#), [Poison Chess](#)) and consumer integration ([Building Dungeon Chess](#) guide) — enabling both variant authors and game builders
- Published [Moddable Hexmaps](#) (v0.5.1) with 4 render styles, procedural generation, URL param API, PNG/PDF/SVG export, and hex metadata system. Built PDF pagination engine for 190+ page rulebook libraries
- Built the entire product suite using LLM-driven development — demonstrating AI-native engineering workflows and framework-level architecture at production scale

Sole developer of Ordzaar prototype; co-authored the SADO open protocol standard and its public SDK, a significant open-source contribution to the Bitcoin developer ecosystem.

- Personally built the first Ordzaar prototype — now the leading Bitcoin Ordinals marketplace and CakeDefi's fifth business vertical
- Co-authored SADO Protocol and led the open-source SDK release at github.com/sadoprotocol — making Ordinals tooling accessible to the developer community
- Promoted from P4 Engineer to M3 Manager; deepened expertise in Schnorr, Taproot, Ordinals, Inscriptions, Runes

Led Malaysia's foremost blockchain infrastructure practice, building products, educating developers and institutions, and shaping the regulatory environment for digital assets in Southeast Asia.

- Authored all curriculum and materials for the StartingBlock Tour (2015) — blockchain developer workshops delivered across 6 European cities in 8 days (Istanbul, Amsterdam, Barcelona, Prague, Berlin, London)
- Ran DBS Bank hackathon infrastructure — 1M+ API requests processed; 7 of 15 teams built on our stack
- Distributed 100+ developer 'hack-pack' USB drives pre-loaded with blockchain tooling across global workshop events
- Authored technical whitepapers, protocol specifications (DN-Key, SADO), and developer documentation
- Delivered training to DBS Bank (Singapore) and Baker Hostetler (USA); contributed to Malaysia's Digital Asset regulatory roadmap

500 Startups Batch 9 (US\$300K+ raised, launched at TechCrunch Disrupt London). Built and promoted open-source wallet and SDK tooling. Featured on CoinDesk and BFM Radio.

- Authored Everstore protocol (2016, 25-page whitepaper) — complete relational database engine on UTXO chains before EVM existed; emerged from DBS hackathon constraints, featured in Blockchain Finance
- Built open-source blockchain wallet framework — the only one with themes and plugins, targeting mainstream developers rather than blockchain specialists
- Two live BFM Radio appearances (2016) — Malaysia's English business radio — explaining blockchain to mainstream audiences
- Core contributor to Automattic's BackPress framework — meaningful contribution to a major open-source ecosystem

TECHNICAL STACK

Bitcoin	UTXO scripting, Schnorr/Taproot, Ordinals, Inscriptions, Runes, BRC-20, BitcoinJS, SADO SDK
Ethereum	Solidity, EthersJS, Web3.js, ERC-20, ERC-721, IPFS, smart contract design
Auth	Passkeys, WebAuthN, FIDO2, DN-Key, cryptographic key management
Backend	Node.js, MongoDB, Neo4j, REST APIs, SDK design, open-source library development
Frontend	React, Svelte, VueJS, Tailwind, ThreeJS, WebGL, Canvas, SVG
AI	LLM-augmented development workflows, AI game engines, procedural generation, prompt engineering
Content	Technical writing, whitepaper authorship, developer guides, live demos, workshop facilitation

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- TEDx speaker (2017) — one of the earliest mainstream Bitcoin talks in Southeast Asia
 - StartingBlock 2015 — authored workshop curriculum delivered across 6 European cities in 8 days
 - Deloitte Top 50 Global RegTech & Digerati50
- DraperVC investment at Oviato — technical work directly contributed to funding outcome
 - First Bitcoin talk at WebCamp KL (2013) — among the earliest blockchain developer presentations in Southeast Asia
 - 500 Startups Batch 9 and Antler Malaysia Batch 2

CREDENTIALS

Registered HRDF Trainer	500 Startups Batch 9 · Antler Malaysia Batch 2
Core contributor — Automattic BackPress (WordPress)	Silver Duke of Edinburgh Award

REFERENCES

Shafiu Hussain	U-Zyn Chua
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